

ZONA NOMAN

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Chicago - Chicago, IL

May 2027 (Expected)

Bachelor of Science: Data Science

- Relevant Coursework: Machine Learning, Probability & Statistics, Linear Programming, Data Science with Python, Databases, R Programming, Discrete Mathematics, Project Management, Finance.
- Women in Computer Science Club (Member).

Girls Who Code - Chicago, IL

July 2023 - August 2023

Data Science

- Introduction to Data Science
- Data Science for Good
- Learned the basics and explored intermediate applications of Python with a focus on data science courses

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Python (pandas, NumPy, matplotlib), R, C/C++, SQL, Swift
- **Modeling & Forecasting:** Regression analysis, demand forecasting, price impact modeling, optimization
- **Tools:** Excel (Advanced – dashboards, PivotTables, VLOOKUP), RStudio, Git, Power-BI, Tableau
- **Methods:** Data cleaning, data visualization, hypothesis testing, statistical inference, stakeholder reporting
- **Soft Skills:** Strategic thinking, cross-functional collaboration, human-centered design, problem-solving
- Cloud computing

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cybersecurity Competition - Capture the Flame - Outreach Member

August 2025 - April 2026

- Drove outreach to universities and institutions to promote Chicago's largest cybersecurity competition, increasing student engagement and participation.
- Led social media strategy by creating and managing content (posts, reels) using editing tools and platforms like Canva; handled ideation, filming, editing, and publishing.
- Coordinated campus-wide marketing efforts by distributing promotional materials across multiple universities.
- Tracked outreach efforts and engagement metrics in Excel to monitor progress and optimize strategies.
- Collaborated with team members through weekly strategy meetings and Discord to align outreach initiatives and execution.
- Engaged with companies and organizations to expand event visibility and build external partnerships.

Discovery Partners Institute - University of Illinois System - Chicago, IL

June 2025 - August 2025

Machine Learning Intern

- Collected 50 research documents that provided trusted recommendations for heat risk, extracted recommendations, and categorized them into 5 types.
- Used Python libraries including pandas, random, numpy, and faker to create synthetic data of 500 users for a profile survey to use to train the recommendation model.
- Created a heat risk recommendation system for user safety from heat exposure for iHEATRISK website, using Flask API with scikit-learn Random Forest classifier.

Program Coordinator

- Coordinated 50 interns at DPI, kept a log of attendance, and resource allocation.
- Developed 15+ social media posts to highlight and recognize program speakers and events across the Chicago tech ecosystem, and increase recognition for the program and organization volunteers.

Discovery Partners Institute - University of Illinois System - Chicago, IL

June 2024 - August 2024

Data Science Intern

- Improved workforce pipeline targeting by filtering, cleaning, and merging Illinois census datasets using RStudio and SQL, enabling IWERC (Illinois Workforce Education and Research Collaborative) to identify underserved regions and optimize resource planning.
- Built trend forecasting models to analyze educational access data across districts, leading to strategic recommendations for state-level policy efforts.
- Analyzed USDA datasets to model airborne virus patterns in poultry farms across 50 states and built Excel dashboards that visualized at-risk zones for faster stakeholder response.
- Reduced manual review time by 40% by optimizing a Gemini-powered AI chatbot in Python that helps A Better Chicago

identify mission-aligned nonprofits.

- Designed demographic dashboards using Excel that visualized high-need areas across Chicago, directly supporting targeted grant allocation decisions.

Discovery Partners Institute - University of Illinois System - Chicago, IL

May 2022 - July 2022

Data Analyst Intern

- Analyzed crime rates in Chicago, IL, using data pulled from the Chicago Data Portal over 2001-2022 as part of a 5-week intensive program with 15 other interns working to understand trends and analyze data using R.
- Analyzed Chicago crime data, identifying 2001 as the peak year, with a decline in crime from 2018 onwards; noted a homicide spike in 2016, a shooting reduction by 2019, and a 64% increase in Downtown shootings in 2022.
- Participated in a speaker series that sparked interest in data science and fostered networking skills by connecting with peers and tech industry professionals.

PROJECTS

Agentic AI APP - Everyone Can Code - Chicago, IL

June 2025 - July 2025

Machine Learning Participant

- Founded Stimtelligent, an agentic AI app built to guide caregivers of nonverbal autistic individuals. It helps them understand different stims and their behaviors. Implemented multimodal stress cue and behavior detection using computer vision and audio signal processing in Python, resulting in real-time personalized caregiver guidance.
- Built and optimized autonomous decision-making pipelines by applying machine learning models for pattern recognition and adaptive response generation, resulting in context-aware recommendations that improved caregiver responsiveness.
- Collaborated on system design and prototyping by integrating Generative AI workflows, data preprocessing pipelines, and model evaluation methods, resulting in a scalable proof-of-concept demonstrating AI's potential in accessibility and healthcare.

Code Your Dreams - Google Office - Chicago, IL

April 2025

Accessibility Hackathon

- Trained a facial expression classifier using Teachable Machine to recognize key emotional states.
- Developed a prototype Emo-Cam, a wearable device for blind users that uses a camera to detect facial expressions and Text-to-Speech with Thunkable to narrate emotions in real-time.
- Trained a machine learning model with Teachable Machine to recognize key expressions (happy, sad, confused, serious), enabling hands-free, accessible interaction.

Personal Project - Remote

January 2025 - May 2025

Career Recommendation System

- Designed a career-matching tool using Python and pandas that suggests roles based on user-selected interests and personality traits.
- Built a custom scoring algorithm to prioritize matches and adjusted logic based on user testing.
- Deployed the logic in a simple, interactive script to simulate guidance for students exploring tech careers.

SparkHacks - University of Illinois Chicago - Chicago, IL

February 2025

Hackathon

- Developed a full-stack web platform to reduce food waste by connecting farmers with surplus produce to nearby food pantries by integrating an AI-powered search tool to determine donation needs, pantry locations, and farm data.
- Designed a user dashboard for donors and pantries, incorporating live data on pantry needs and streamlining communication.

Code Your Dreams - Google Office - Chicago, IL

April 2023

Accessibility Hackathon

- Coded and collaborated with deaf kids during the Accessibility Ideathon 2023.
- Developed an accessibility app using MIT App Inventor, designed to help hard-of-hearing children communicate with doctors during health appointments, and presented its structure and model.
- Won the Most Impactful App Award.

Nasa Space Apps Hackathon - Chicago, IL

October 2025

AI Powered Dashboard - Award Winner

- Built Brickonaut, an AI-powered research dashboard that semantically searches and visualizes insights from 600+ NASA bioscience publications, helping users identify trends, knowledge gaps, and research consensus.
- Developed backend infrastructure using Python, Flask, and pandas, integrating Azure OpenAI and Semantic Kernel SDK for AI-driven summarization and insight generation.
- Collaborated on interactive data visualizations with D3.js and led project storytelling, earning the Storytelling Award at

Co-founder & IOS Engineer

- Co-founded TrustPath, an IOS app designed to match individuals on parole/probation with community volunteers, facilitating structured mentor-mentee relationships and appointment tracking, while leveraging AI to accelerate implementation.
- Led and Architected Firebase backend integration using Swift, Firestore, and Clean Architecture (MVVM + Repository Pattern), implementing async/await workflows for real-time user persistence, profile serialization, and match assignment pipelines with scalable cloud consistency.
- Collaborated within a 4-person engineering team to design system architecture, implement business logic services (UserService, MatchingService, CalendarService), and ship a production-ready app to the Apple App Store.